

# The Windswept Shores of Troy

The windswept shores of Troy stretch along a bright Aegean sea, where wooden ships with painted eyes lie beached on the long sand and a great city of honey-coloured walls stands proud on the hill above. For a long while two camps, the weary seafarers on the beach and the proud city behind its gates, have been caught in a tired old quarrel that neither truly wants. Across the wine-dark sea lies the long road home, full of wonders: a loyal old hound, a keeper of the winds, and lonely sea-singers on the rocks. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who is clever, brave, and keeps faith with a friend. The grandest deeds are done not with spears but with a good idea and a kind heart, and the oldest quarrels often end with a single brave act of friendship.



# Who's Who and What's What

## Places

**The Great Walls of Troy** - The high, honey-coloured walls of the proud city on the hill, with great gates that have stayed shut through the long quarrel, and watchful but weary folk behind them.

**The Isle of Winds** - A floating island ringed with bronze cliffs where the keeper of the winds lives, and where a fair wind can be asked for with a clever and courteous word.

**The Ship Camp** - The seafarers' camp of tents and beached wooden ships along the long windswept beach, the heroes' home, with cook-fires and friendly faces and the sea always near.

**The Weaving Hall** - Home at last, across the sea: a warm hall where a great loom stands, a homecoming feast is laid, and old friends and a faithful hound are waiting.

**The Wine-Dark Sea** - The wide, deep sea that lies between the shores of Troy and home, beautiful and changeable, the great road of the long voyage back.

## Characters

**Aeolus, Keeper of the Winds** - The gentle keeper of the winds on his floating isle, who lends a fair wind to travellers who ask cleverly and kindly, and never out of greed.



**Odysseus the Clever** - The famously clever captain of the seafarers, who prizes a good idea over a strong arm and sends the heroes out with a clever plan and a kind word.

**Thetis the Sea-Mother** - A gentle sea goddess who calms the waves and smiles on heroes that win by thinking and caring rather than by force.

## Creatures

**Argos the Faithful Hound** - A loyal old dog who never forgets a friend or a scent, and who helps the heroes track down what is lost along the shore. Loyalty itself, with a wagging tail.

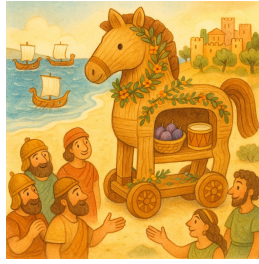
**The Singing Sirens** - Sea-singers on a rocky isle whose song is beautiful but sad and lonely. They are not wicked, only longing for company, and once cheered and befriended they sing travellers safely on their way.

## Items

**Penelope's Thread** - A ball of strong weaving thread. Tie one end where you start and you can always find your way back, and it is handy for measuring and lashing besides.

**The Basket of Honey and Figs** - A basket of sweet honey and ripe figs. Shared with a wary stranger or a lonely singer, it can turn a frown into a friend.

**The Conch Horn** - A great spiral seashell that sounds a warm, calling note. Its sound carries a friendly message across the water and can soothe a troubled or lonely heart.



**The Great Wooden Horse** - A huge wooden horse on wheels that the heroes build. Filled not with soldiers but with gifts, music, and a hand of friendship, it can surprise a proud city into peace.

## Words to Know

**Cleverness** - Quick thinking and a clever plan. On these shores, a good idea ends a quarrel that a thousand spears never could.

**Courage** - A steady heart on a wide and stormy sea. Courage is not being unafraid; it is being kind and clever even when you are afraid.

**Loyalty** - Standing by your friends and leaving no one behind. The greatest heroes of the shores are the ones who keep faith, help, and find their way home together.

# Idea Bank: The Windswept Shores of Troy

*Improv prompts for the grown-up. When the children want to try something the page did not plan for, reach in here. Nothing is a wrong answer; every idea bends toward cleverness, friendship, and nobody losing.*

## If the heroes are stuck

- Odysseus the Clever wanders past, rubs his beard, and asks a question that is really a hint in disguise.
- Argos the Faithful Hound trots up, sniffs, and points his nose the right way.
- A gull wheels overhead and drops a feather on the thing that matters.
- Let the heroes spend an energy star to "remember a trick an old sailor taught them".

## Friendly faces to drop in

- A weary city guard who would rather share a fig than keep a gate shut.
- A dolphin who will show the safe channel for a kind word.
- A child on the walls who waves, curious, and could become a friend.
- An old shipwright who knows just how to make the timbers balance.

## Gentle troubles to solve

- A heavy thing to move that only works if everyone lifts together.
- A row of ships to count, or planks to measure with Penelope's thread.
- A sad song across the water that asks to be answered, not fled.
- A gate that opens not to a push but to a gift and a friendly word.

## Ways to win that are not winning

- End the quarrel with a surprise of friendship instead of a show of strength.
- Trade a basket of figs for a story rather than for the way through.
- Sing back to the lonely sirens until their song turns glad.
- Leave every shore kinder and every friend closer than you found them.

## Aegean flavour to sprinkle

- Salt wind and the creak of timber, painted eyes on the prows, white sails snapping.
- Honey-coloured walls in the sun, olive trees, the smell of figs and cook-fires.
- The wine-dark sea at dawn, a faithful dog on the sand, a conch horn far off.

## Stories in this world

**Argos and the Lost Keepsake** (young). The ships are nearly ready to sail home across the sea.

**The Great Wooden Horse** (young). For a long, long time the two camps on the windswept shores of Troy have been cross with each other.

**The Long Way Home** (older). The long quarrel is over, and it ended not with spears but with friendship.

# Wits and Wonder

## World Book

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.